



JOURNEY OF THE SMARTPHONE

For decades, smartphones have been shaping the world around us. Here's a look at how they've evolved over the years.

Sushant Talwar | feedback@digit.in

20 years is a long time in the world of technology. Over the past two decades (2001 to 2021) advancements in tech have not only shaped, but at times completely changed, the world around us. Case in point, the rise of smartphones during this period.

HOW DID WE GET HERE?

In 2007, Apple decided to change the game by ripping up what had started to become the blueprint for smartphones back in the day. It revolutionised the industry by launching the



Simon Personal Communicator

first iPhone -- a smartphone unlike any that we had seen before. With its futuristic design, and technology, the iPhone changed not only how we looked at smartphones, but also how we interacted with them.

Unlike previous generation smartphones which relied on QWERTY keypads, and slow browsers to connect us to the Internet, this smartphone from Apple used a large touchscreen display which could not only flip through websites, applications and games, but could also turn into a convenient keyboard when you wanted to type a long email. And interestingly, it did all this while looking sleeker than anything that had launched before.

In a way, the memory of the first iPhone lives on even today as arguably almost all modern-day smartphones still use the basic blueprint that a certain Steve Jobs used to craft the phone back in 2007. Despite featuring staggering technological upgrades, almost all smartphones since the launch of the first iPhone have followed the template of being glass and metal slabs, which use touch-screen displays to communicate with the end user.

Yet, despite following this basic template, the modern-day smartphone has managed to emerge a very different beast to its predecessors. Years and years of incremental

upgrades have ensured that the smartphone of today feels nothing like its father from 2007. While it takes a lot to make a smartphone, it is the technological advancements in a few areas which has truly elevated the smartphone into a modern-day necessity. These areas are also expected to see rapid growth in the



Apple iPhone

coming years, ultimately changing not only how the smartphone behaves, but also how it looks.

SMARTPHONE DESIGNS

Even though the modern-day smartphone has evolved into something that feels nothing like the first smartphones, it still looks much like it in essence. However, that's something that could change in the coming years. After following the same metal and glass slab design blueprint for over a decade, smartphone manufacturers have finally started to try some more ambitious forms. Multiple displays, folding designs

Photo courtesy: www.pixellia.com Free Stock Photos, CCO, via Wikimedia Commons